NITAZOXANIDE

Take with food

Yellow urine

CHEMICAL NAME [2-[(5-nitro-1,3-thiazol-2-yl)carbamoyl]phenyl] acetate
CLASS Thiazolide antiprotozoal and anthelmintic
TRADE NAMES Alinia · Nitazode · Nanazoxid

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Diarrhoea caused by *Giardia lamblia* and *Cryptosporidium parvum* (children and adults).
- Amoebiasis; rotavirus/norovirus diarrhoea (off-label in some countries).
- Some helminths (tapeworm).

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Inhibits **pyruvate:ferredoxin oxidoreductase (PFOR)** enzyme-dependent electron transfer → disrupts anaerobic energy metabolism of protozoa.

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** tablets or suspension with food.
- Shake suspension well.

DOSAGES

- **Adults & children ≥12 yr:** 500 mg every 12 h for 3 days.
- **Children 4–11 yr:** 200 mg (10 mL) every 12 h for 3 days.
- **Children 1–3 yr:** 100 mg (5 mL) every 12 h for 3 days.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Abdominal pain, nausea, headache.
- Diarrhoea.
- Yellow discoloration of urine and eyes (sclera) — harmless.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Hypersensitivity (rare).
- Raised liver enzymes (rare).

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Peak:** 1–4 h. Absorption doubled with food.
- Rapidly hydrolysed to active tizoxanide.
- Excreted in urine, bile and faeces. **t½:** ~1.5 h (tizoxanide).

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Hypersensitivity.
- **Caution:** hepatic, renal or biliary disease; diabetes (suspension contains sucrose).

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Warfarin:** highly protein-bound; monitor INR.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Give with food.
- Assess hydration, stool frequency and character; give ORS.
- Stool test follow-up if symptoms persist.
- Hygiene and infection-control advice.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take with food twice a day for 3 days.
- Urine may turn bright yellow; harmless.
- Drink ORS to replace fluids.
- Wash hands well; use safe drinking water.

KEY POINTS

- Thiazolide for Giardia and Cryptosporidium.
- Yellow urine is harmless.
- 3-day course with food.
- Rehydration remains essential.

SOURCES CHECKED **[262]** Nitazoxanide, oral (US label) **[263]** Nitazoxanide, oral (US label, e5 Pharma)

Full references p. 432–457